

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DEED

Date: 5/14/2026

Bill Number: SB 187

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): School Nutrition/Meal: Prohibit Food Dyes

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☐ SIGN ☐ VETO ☒ LWOS

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

Allowing SB187 to become law without signature acknowledges the Legislature's intent to promote healthier school meal standards while avoiding an explicit endorsement of the bill's operational challenges. The bill supports student wellness by eliminating certain artificial food dyes from school meals, aligning with broader public health priorities. However, it also imposes an unfunded mandate on school districts and assigns responsibilities to the department without providing the necessary resources or enforcement authority to ensure effective implementation. Permitting the bill to take effect without signature recognizes the value of its public health objectives while signaling concern regarding its fiscal and administrative gaps. This approach maintains respect for legislative intent while preserving the administration's position on unfunded mandates and incomplete statutory frameworks.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

SB187 prohibits public schools from serving foods or beverages containing certain artificial food

CONFIDENTIAL & DELIBERATIVE

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

dyes as part of breakfast or lunch programs provided to enrolled students during the school day. Specifically, the bill prohibits the use of Red Dye 3, Red Dye 40, Yellow Dye 5, Yellow Dye 6, Blue Dye 1, Blue Dye 2, and Green Dye 3 in foods and beverages served through public school meal programs. The bill would take effect January 1, 2028.

Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Section 1 of the bill imposes a ban on seven synthetic food dyes in public schools, as established in AS 14.03. The specific dyes that would be banned from breakfast or lunch provided by the school to enroll students during a school day:

Red dye 3 (U.S. Chemical Abstracts Service no. 16423-68-0);
Red dye 40 (U.S. Chemical Abstracts Service no. 25956-17-6);
Yellow dye 5 (U.S. Chemical Abstracts Service no. 1934-21-0);
Yellow dye 6 (U.S. Chemical Abstracts Service no. 2783-94-0);
Blue dye 1 (U.S. Chemical Abstracts Service no. 3844-45-9);
Blue dye 2 (U.S. Chemical Abstracts Service no. 860-22-0); and
Green dye 3 (U.S. Chemical Abstracts Service no. 2353-45-9)

Section 2 sets an effective date, July 1, 2025

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

None

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phones numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

Click or tap here to enter text.

Commissioner’s Signature: _____



Date: 5.14.2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor’s Legislative Office for

CONFIDENTIAL & DELIBERATIVE

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

CONFIDENTIAL & DELIBERATIVE